

Nikki Schlesinger

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Senior Product/Program Manager with 10+ years of experience across tech, consumer, and financial services, blending expertise in product, marketing, and operations to deliver customer-centric solutions. Proven track record of driving innovation, growth, and operational excellence through data-driven strategies and cross-functional collaboration.

Highlights

- **Led cross-functional team of 80+ across product, design, engineering and data insights to launch Podcast Advertising on Spotify's self-serve Ad Platform**, integrating ad creation, brand safety, reporting, and payments, driving \$1.4B in ad revenue, a 68% YoY increase (2021). Partnered with sales and marketing to define unique value propositions, implement GTM plans, and inform sales teams.
- **Launched Spotify Advertising's product marketing website**, leading 30+ cross-functional team members from concept to implementation; partnered with brand and editorial to establish the brand identity, articulate the product value, and establish a new digital channel for advertiser engagement and acquisition.
- **Directed editorial calendars and marketing roadmaps at DIRECTV**, aligning channel marketing with product milestones, seasonal campaigns and business goals; drove creative development and messaging strategy across channels, coordinating campaign planning, creative development, cross-channel messaging, and GTM execution, contributing to 220K+ new subscribers quarterly.
- **Effective communicator and cross-functional leader**, served as operations lead for a 100+ person ad group at Spotify; led quarterly planning and project prioritization, established business ways of working, built team onboarding tools, managed leadership communications, facilitated weekly leadership alignment forums, resolved cross-team blockers, and ensured transparency and accountability.
- **Led product redesign of American Express customer acquisition website**, resulting in 11% YoY increase in new accounts; developed upsell/cross-sell marketing strategies for core products, launching campaigns that generated \$3.5B in annual revenue, and 700k new accounts annually.

DIRECTV

New York, NY

5/2023-12/2025

Senior Product Marketing Manager | Marketing Acquisition (Contract)

Develop product strategies that drive targeted marketing tactics for acquiring new DIRECTV subscribers, leveraging cross-funnel advertising to optimize engagement and conversion.

- Led campaign strategy developing unique value propositions and messaging, partnering with GTM teams to execute cross-channel campaigns resulting in 220K+ new subscribers quarterly.
- Executed brand marketing strategies that increased streaming product awareness by 35% and shifted product mix by 7% toward higher-margin streaming products.
- Streamlined campaign briefing process improving advertising operations, increasing efficiency and campaign effectiveness.

SPOTIFY

New York, NY

6/2020-12/2022

Program Manager/Strategic Operations Lead | Spotify Advertising

Oversaw end-to-end execution of critical, large-scale strategic products. Developed product strategy, defined business requirements, developed PRDs, built roadmaps, established operational protocols, managed cross-functional teams, facilitated communications, and ensured accountability throughout delivery. Selected as Operation lead for the self-serve Ad Manager team (100+ cross-functional people).

- Led a cross-functional team of 80+ to launch podcast advertising on Spotify's self-serve ad platform, integrating ad creation, brand safety, reporting, and payments into the Ad platform. Partnered with sales and marketing for a seamless rollout, driving \$5M in revenue in the initial rollout.
- Launched Spotify Advertising's product marketing website, driving customer acquisition and loyalty. Developed product strategy, ways of working, and delivery plan, and managed a cross-functional 30+ person project team from design to delivery.
- Directed weekly cross-functional alignment, communicated program status, managed risks, and fostered collaboration across product, design, engineering, sales, marketing, and legal.
- Led strategic and operational efforts for a 100+ person team; oversaw business planning, project and feature prioritization, onboarding, communications, and team culture.

COMCAST NBC UNIVERSAL

New York, NY

9/2018-6/2020

Program Manager | Experience Design, Digital Home

Led program management for the Xfinity Digital Home web and native applications.

- Led agile planning and cross-functional collaboration to deliver against business goals.
- Facilitated sprint planning, backlog grooming, feature prioritization, and defined business requirements aligned with OKRs for a team of 16 designers.

AMERICAN EXPRESS

New York, NY

1/2016-9/2017

Senior Product Manager | Card Member Acquisition

Managed acquisition website for American Express US Consumer with over 1M monthly unique visitors.

- Led redesign of customer acquisition website, driving an 11% YoY increase in new accounts. Defined UX, creative execution, and agency/technology deliverables.
- Developed customer marketing acquisition strategy for core products, launching campaigns that generated \$3.5B in revenue and 700K new accounts annually.
- Conducted A/B and multivariate testing to optimize performance, refined content strategy, and created a KPI scorecard to track results.
- Led the RFP process for the new agency; responsibilities included scope definition, RFP evaluation, contract negotiation, and agency onboarding.
- Ensured compliance with regulatory requirements by collaborating with legal, compliance, and operations teams through a rigorous approval process.

Senior Product Manager | Enterprise Growth

2/2010-12/2015

Led digital new product development for an international portfolio of prepaid products, generating over \$689MM across eight global markets: Australia, Brazil, Canada, China, India, Mexico, South Africa, and UK.

- Led product discovery and strategy, product UX development, user testing, feature prioritization, usability testing, and program delivery for prepaid products.
- Managed one Analyst and two MBA interns; launched a Mentor program to enhance leadership effectiveness and employee satisfaction.

Senior Product Manager | Global Prepaid Services / Personal Savings

4/2008-2/2010

Led Global Prepaid business through strategic online enhancements and marketing initiatives, resulting in \$88M in sales and 60% growth YOY.

- Launched Personal Savings product from 0-1, driving \$1B in deposits and enabling online savings fund management. Defined strategy, UX, and creative for marketing, servicing, and sales websites.
- Led redesign of gift card website and optimized acquisition channels. Conducted user research and multivariate testing, boosting sales, conversion rates, and user satisfaction.
- Developed seasonal Gift Card marketing campaigns executed across Amex.com channels.

Product Manager | Premium Charge Card / Prepaid Services

3/2005-4/2008

- Platinum and Centurion Cards - Led development of premium Cards online experiences, increasing loyalty, deepening user engagement, and driving spend.
- Travelers Cheques and Prepaid Services - Developed strategic vision and customer experience to support new product development for a Teen Card.

Additional Experience

- **Organic** - Digital Agency, Engagement Manager; San Francisco, CA/New York, NY
- **Deloitte Consulting**, Creative Services Manager; Foster City, CA

Education**University of Colorado, Boulder, CO**

Bachelor of Science (B.S) in Journalism, School of Journalism and Mass Communication